

FICTIONAL HR POLICY - RETRIEVAL TEST FIXTURE

Annual leave

Employees receive 20 working days of annual leave each calendar year. Requests for a planned vacation must be submitted in the HR portal at least ten working days before departure. The reporting manager approves leave based on team coverage. Up to five unused annual leave days may be carried forward into the next year and must be used by March 31. Remaining unused days expire. Annual leave is separate from casual leave and sick leave. Public holidays inside a vacation are not deducted from the annual leave balance.

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Casual leave

Employees may take six days of casual leave per calendar year for urgent personal matters such as household appointments or family errands. No more than two consecutive casual leave days may be taken in one request. Inform the reporting manager before the workday begins whenever possible. Unused casual leave expires at year end and cannot be carried forward or paid out. Casual leave is distinct from planned annual vacations and from sick leave used for illness. The HR portal shows the remaining casual leave balance.

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Sick leave

Employees receive ten paid sick leave days each year when illness or injury prevents work. Notify the reporting manager as soon as possible on the first day of absence. A medical certificate is required for sickness lasting more than two consecutive working days. Sick leave cannot be substituted for planned vacation. Employees returning after a serious illness may discuss temporary workplace adjustments with HR. Unused sick days expire at the end of the calendar year. Medical records must be shared privately with HR rather than posted in team channels.

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Maternity leave

Under this fictional company policy, eligible employees may take 26 weeks of paid maternity leave for childbirth. Notify HR with the expected delivery date and a medical certificate at least eight weeks before the planned start when practical. Maternity leave does not reduce the annual or casual leave balance. HR confirms the approved dates in writing. Any medically necessary extension requires a separate discussion with HR. Returning employees may request a gradual return schedule. This demonstration policy is synthetic and is not legal guidance or a statement of statutory eligibility.

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Parental leave for partners

An employee whose spouse or partner gives birth may take ten working days of paid partner parental leave. This leave must be used within six months of the birth and can be split into two blocks. Submit a birth record and the requested dates to HR. Partner leave is a separate benefit from maternity leave and annual vacation. The reporting manager arranges coverage during the absence. Employees adopting a child should consult the adoption policy, which has different duration and documentation requirements. Unused partner leave is not paid out.

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Adoption leave

A primary caregiver adopting a child may take twelve weeks of paid adoption leave. Provide HR with the official placement document and expected placement date. The leave begins on the date the child is placed with the employee. A secondary caregiver may request ten working days of adoption support leave. Adoption leave is independent of maternity leave, which covers childbirth. Employees should give four weeks of notice where placement timing permits. HR keeps adoption records confidential and coordinates a return date with the employee and reporting manager.

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Probation period

New permanent employees serve a six month probation period from their joining date. The reporting manager reviews performance at three months and again before the end of probation. HR issues a written confirmation after successful completion. Probation may be extended once by up to three months if performance expectations have not yet been met. During probation, resignation requires fifteen calendar days of notice. After confirmation, the regular notice period applies. Completion of six months alone does not replace written confirmation. Contractors are governed by their individual agreements.

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Notice period after confirmation

Confirmed permanent employees must give sixty calendar days of written notice when resigning. Submit the resignation to the reporting manager and HR through the employee portal. The notice period begins when the written resignation is received. HR may approve a shorter period or salary in lieu of notice, but this is not automatic. Employees must complete handover and return company assets before their final working day. The fifteen day probation notice rule applies only to employees who have not yet received written confirmation.

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Work from home

Employees in eligible roles may work from home up to two days per week with prior approval from their reporting manager. Submit the requested days in the HR portal. Employees must be reachable during core hours of 10 a.m. to 4 p.m. and use the company VPN for internal systems. Working from home is not leave and does not reduce attendance requirements. Roles requiring physical equipment or customer site presence may be excluded. Working from another country requires separate written approval from HR and information security.

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Flexible working hours

Employees may start their workday between 8 a.m. and 10 a.m. with manager agreement, while completing eight working hours excluding meal breaks. All team members must be available during core collaboration hours from 10 a.m. to 4 p.m. Flexible hours change the daily schedule, not the number of required hours or the permitted work location. Employees seeking to work from home must use the remote work policy. Repeated late arrival outside the agreed schedule should be discussed with the reporting manager.

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POSH complaints

The Prevention of Sexual Harassment policy, also called POSH, provides a confidential reporting route to the Internal Committee. Employees may submit a written complaint describing workplace sexual harassment to the committee through the designated confidential HR channel. HR can help an employee prepare the complaint without deciding its outcome. The committee handles review and investigation, and retaliation against a complainant or witness is prohibited. Managers must not investigate complaints themselves or discuss them in public team meetings. General payroll and performance concerns belong in the grievance process.

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General grievances

Employees with concerns about payroll errors, unfair task allocation, or workplace treatment unrelated to sexual harassment should submit a grievance to HR. Include dates, relevant records, and the outcome requested. HR acknowledges the grievance within three working days and aims to provide an initial response within ten working days. Employees may escalate an unresolved grievance to the head of HR. Sexual harassment complaints must instead be routed to the POSH Internal Committee under its confidential procedure. Retaliation for raising a good faith concern is prohibited.

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Gratuity

This synthetic policy describes a gratuity benefit for eligible permanent employees who complete five years of continuous service. HR calculates the benefit using the applicable service record and final eligible salary when employment ends. Employees should verify their joining date and beneficiary details in the HR portal. Gratuity is separate from monthly payroll, retirement fund contributions, and performance bonuses. The final amount and any exceptions require HR review under applicable rules. These fictional examples are for retrieval testing only and must not be treated as legal or financial advice.

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Retirement fund

Eligible employees and the company contribute to the retirement provident fund through monthly payroll deductions. The monthly payslip lists employee and employer contributions separately. Employees should update their retirement account identifier and nomination details through HR. Changes to nomination do not change the monthly contribution rate. Retirement fund contributions are separate from gratuity paid on eligible separation and from discretionary performance bonuses. Questions about missing deposits should be raised with payroll using the relevant payslip and account statement. HR does not provide individual investment advice.

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Travel reimbursement

Business travel expenses must be submitted within thirty calendar days of completing the trip. Attach itemized receipts, the approved travel request, and a short business purpose. Reimbursement covers approved transport, accommodation, and meals within the published limits. Personal sightseeing costs and expenses for accompanying family members are not reimbursable. The reporting manager approves the claim before finance processes payment. Missing receipts require a written exception from finance. Home internet expenses follow the remote work allowance policy rather than the business travel reimbursement process.

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Remote work allowance

Employees approved for regular remote work may claim home internet costs up to 1500 currency units per month. Submit the monthly internet bill with the claim in the HR portal by the tenth day of the following month. The allowance covers connectivity only and does not pay for household furniture or personal streaming subscriptions. Unused allowance cannot be carried into another month. Company laptops are provided through information technology and must not be purchased under this allowance. Business travel claims use a separate expense procedure.

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Overtime

Overtime requires advance written approval from the reporting manager. Eligible employees record additional hours in the timekeeping system with the work performed and approval reference. Working late without approval does not automatically qualify for overtime payment. HR determines eligibility based on the employee category and applicable rules. Compensatory time off may be approved where appropriate and must be used within sixty days. Normal flexible start times do not constitute overtime if the employee still works the usual daily hours. This fictional policy is intended only as a software demonstration.

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Public holidays

The company publishes a location specific public holiday calendar at the start of each year. Employees follow the calendar assigned to their primary work location, including while temporarily working from home. Public holidays are not deducted from annual leave. Employees required to work on a listed holiday must obtain manager approval and may receive compensatory time off under the overtime policy. Optional holidays require an advance request through the HR portal. A holiday falling on a weekend does not automatically create a substitute day unless the published calendar states otherwise.

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Bereavement leave

Employees may take three paid working days of bereavement leave following the death of an immediate family member. Notify the reporting manager or HR as soon as practical. HR may request supporting information sensitively after the employee returns. Bereavement leave is separate from casual leave and annual vacation. Additional time for travel or family responsibilities may be requested from the annual leave balance or as unpaid leave with approval. Immediate family includes a spouse, partner, parent, child, sibling, or an equivalent dependent relationship reviewed by HR.

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Unpaid leave

Employees who have exhausted available paid leave may request unpaid leave for exceptional personal circumstances. Approval is discretionary and requires both the reporting manager and HR to agree on dates and business coverage. Unpaid leave reduces salary for the approved absence and may affect benefit accrual. Employees must obtain approval before the absence begins except in an emergency. Unpaid leave is not automatically granted when an annual leave request is declined. HR explains any impact on service records and benefits in writing before the employee confirms the request.

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Performance reviews

Formal performance reviews take place twice each year, in June and December. Employees complete a self assessment before discussing goals, results, and development needs with their reporting manager. Ratings are reviewed for consistency across teams. A performance review does not guarantee a salary increase or bonus. New employees also have separate probation checkpoints at three and six months. Employees who disagree with a recorded review may provide a written response to HR. Review documents are confidential and accessible only to the employee, relevant managers, and authorized HR staff.

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Learning reimbursement

Employees may request reimbursement for job relevant courses up to 20000 currency units each financial year. Obtain manager approval before enrolling and attach the course outline and cost. Reimbursement requires proof of payment and successful completion. Optional books and personal interest courses are not covered unless explicitly approved as job relevant. The annual learning budget cannot be carried forward. Mandatory compliance training is arranged and paid for directly by the company and does not consume this individual budget. HR maintains the record of completed training.

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Data confidentiality

Employees must store HR records and customer information only in approved company systems. Do not copy confidential documents to personal email accounts or public file sharing services. Share information only with colleagues who need it for their work. Report suspected disclosure immediately to information security and HR. Confidentiality obligations continue after employment ends. Remote employees must use the company VPN and lock their screen when away from the device. Medical, grievance, and POSH records require restricted access and must never be posted in general team channels.

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Exit and final settlement

On separation, employees must return their laptop, access card, and any other company assets by the final working day. The reporting manager signs off the handover and information technology confirms asset return. Finance aims to complete final settlement within thirty calendar days after all clearances are received. Settlement includes outstanding eligible salary and approved expenses, subject to applicable deductions. Gratuity eligibility is reviewed separately under the gratuity policy. An experience letter is issued after exit clearance. The resignation notice duration is specified in the notice period policy.